downtown and have a leisurely lunch at some fine restaurant.

Into town I drove and learned the hard way about parking spots and their nonexistence, about downtown lunch-hour traffic and their nonmobility, about one-way streets and their nonpredictability. It took me nearly an hour to get back and then I parked the car at Howard Johnson's, trembling so hard I could hardly hold the wheel—and when I calmed down, I ate there. It was a valuable lesson.

*7

On August 29, 1950,1 drove to New York for the first time. It took me seven hours, counting time for getting gasoline and having my oil changed, but I did it without getting lost and without accident.

Once in New York, I gave more of The Stars, like Dust— to Brad and promised him the last three chapters within two weeks.

On the thirty-first, I celebrated my new mobility by driving Gertrude to Campbell's in Elizabeth and having lunch with him there. Hubert Rogers, the illustrator, was with us and he amused me enormously by telling Campbell calmly that he thought Hubbard was a faker and that dianetics was nonsense. I kept my mouth shut, since Rogers clearly needed no help.

Then I drove Gertrude to Windsor Place, parked the car there, went into Manhattan, came back, got the car, and drove to the Bluger-mans\ Who would have thought, a quarter year before, that I would be driving everywhere like this?

One of the things we did in Manhattan was to visit Gold. He gave us a copy of the October 1950 Galaxy, the first issue, which contained "Darwinian Poolroom." 6 When I read the issue I had to agree, with some awe, that Horace had put together just about the best issue of any science-fiction magazine I had ever seen. My own story was the weakest thing in it.

Horace kept it up, too. From the first issue, Galaxy was in a tie with Astounding for the title of best magazine, in the eyes of most fans. Many of them (even I, myself) felt that Galaxy had a bit the better of it.

Much less important was the fact that the November 1950 Future Fiction contained "Day of the Hunters." 7

Henry Blugerman had a job again, as superintendent at a paper-box firm, and